

What is a Web Application?

A web application is an **application programme** stored on a remote server and accessed through a web browser. Unlike traditional desktop software, web apps enable **user interaction and task completion** through various interactive elements.

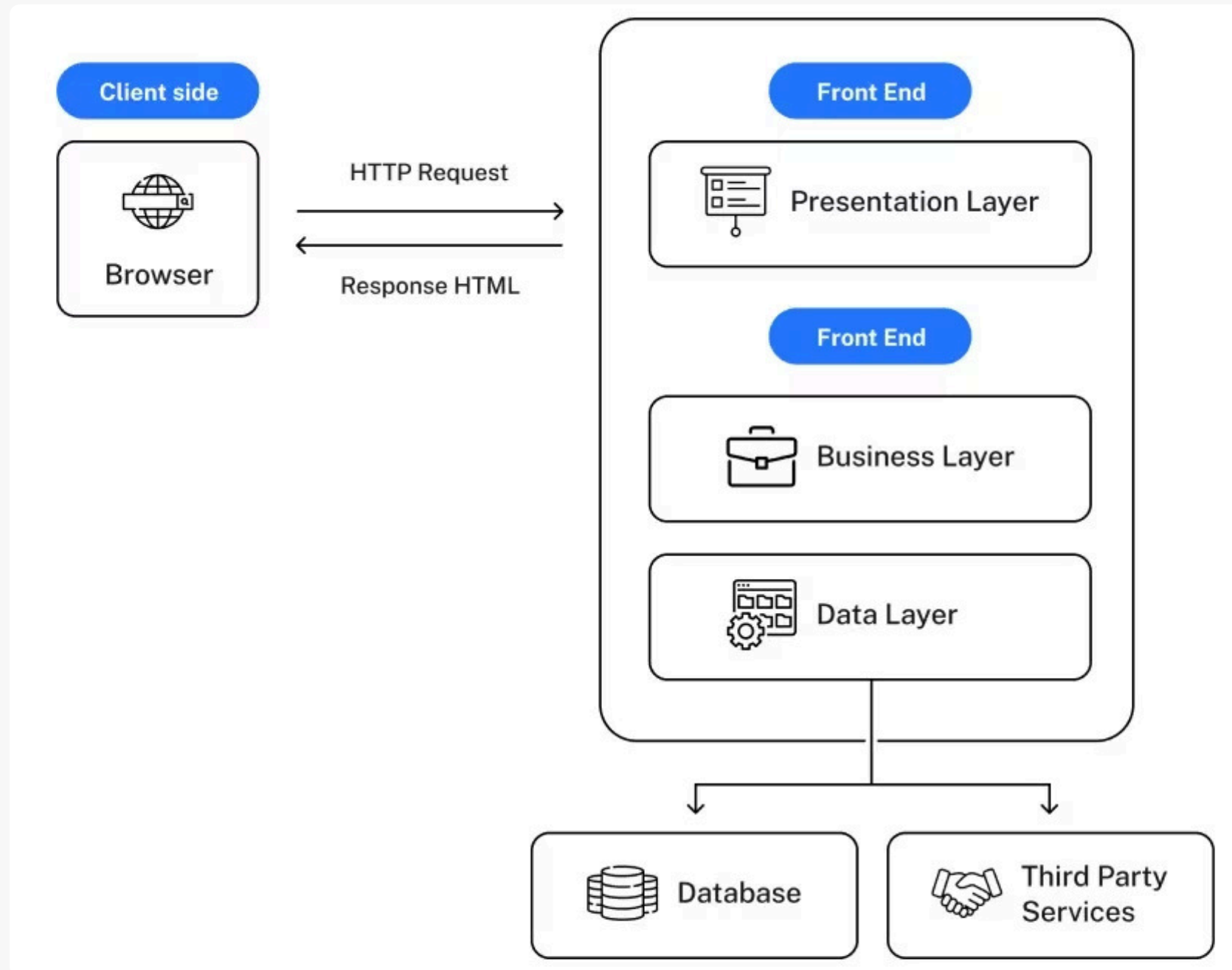
What sets web applications apart from standard websites is their focus on functionality rather than just information display. They work on **any device with a browser**—whether mobile phone, tablet, or personal computer—making them incredibly versatile and accessible.

How Web Applications Work

Web applications operate on a **client-server model**, where the user's web browser acts as the client and communicates with a remote server. This interaction enables dynamic content delivery and functionality, distinguishing them from static websites.

When a user interacts with a web application, their browser (**client**) sends a request to the server. The **server** then processes this request, often retrieving or updating information in a database. Finally, the server generates a response, typically in HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, which is sent back to the browser for the client to render and display.

Web Application Architecture



Components and Examples of Web Applications

Presentation Layer

The front-end interface users interact with in their browser. Typically built using HTML, CSS and JavaScript, providing visual elements and controls.

Business Logic Layer

The application's core functionality that processes user requests and applies business rules. Often developed using languages like PHP, Python, Ruby or JavaScript.

Data Storage Layer

Manages persistence of application data, typically using database systems like MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB or cloud-based solutions.

Modern web applications frequently integrate **third-party APIs** (Application Programming Interfaces) to extend functionality without building everything from scratch. Common examples include payment processors, mapping services, and social media integration.

Popular web applications we use daily include **Amazon** for e-commerce, **Gmail** for webmail, **Facebook** for social networking, and various online banking platforms.